

KS3: Causes of the Great War

"How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?"

MASTERY PACK: COMPLETE UNIT

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 140 Crucial Questions



Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

meoncross-history.netlify.app/units/great_war/mastery_pack_full.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

-  **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
-  **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
-  **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	How many independent states existed in Central Europe before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which state was the most powerful among the German states before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Who became the Prime Minister of Prussia in 1862?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What was Bismarck's famous phrase for how Germany would be unified?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What did 'blood and iron' mean in Bismarck's approach?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Which three countries did Prussia defeat to unify Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
7	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War begin?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Where was the King of Prussia proclaimed the first German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
9	When was the German Empire officially created?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which valuable French territory did Germany seize in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What was the economic union created by Prussia in 1834 called?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Which major German-speaking power was deliberately excluded from the Zollverein?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What was the German term for the new German Empire?	☐	☐	☐	
14	How long did it take the Prussian army to crush Austria in 1866?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
15	Who was the first Emperor (Kaiser) of the newly unified Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
16	Why did Bismarck provoke a war with France in 1870?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which French Emperor was captured by the Prussian military?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What natural resources was Alsace-Lorraine rich in?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What long-term effect did the taking of Alsace-Lorraine have?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Why was the unification of Germany a shock to the balance of power in Europe?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

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Date: _____

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Who was the Chancellor of Prussia that orchestrated the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
22	Which telegram did Bismarck edit to provoke France into war?	☐	☐	☐	
23	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War break out?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Which two provinces were taken from France in the peace settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
25	Where was the German Empire proclaimed in 1871, humiliating the French?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What was the size of the war indemnity France was forced to pay?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Who became the new German Emperor in 1888 and dismissed Bismarck?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What secret treaty did Bismarck sign with Russia that Wilhelm II allowed to expire?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Which country allied with Russia in 1894 after Bismarck's dismissal?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What was Germany's greatest fear that drove its military planning?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What was the name of the German military plan created to defeat France quickly?	☐	☐	☐	
32	Which French leader was captured at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
33	What was the primary goal of Bismarck in defeating France?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
34	Which French territory was annexed by Germany, creating lasting resentment?	☐	☐	☐	
35	Who was the Prussian King that was crowned German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
36	What event did Bismarck use to trick France into declaring war?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What happened to Napoleon III at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What treaty formally ended the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Why did Bismarck fear a French alliance with Russia?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Where exactly was the new German Empire proclaimed?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What term describes the rapid colonization and partition of Africa by European powers between 1881 and 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
42	Which European monarch claimed the Congo Free State as his personal private property, brutally exploiting it for rubber and ivory?	☐	☐	☐	
43	In which year did Otto von Bismarck convene the Berlin Conference to establish ground rules for European colonization in Africa?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Which German leader launched Weltpolitik and famously demanded Germany's 'place in the sun' in Africa and beyond?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Which European power controlled the largest and most commercially valuable empire in Africa by 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
46	In which year did Kaiser Wilhelm II land in Tangier, sparking the First Moroccan Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What did Kaiser Wilhelm II publicly declare during his dramatic 1905 visit to Tangier?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What was the primary outcome of the 1906 Algeiras Conference for Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What aggressive German military action triggered the Second Moroccan Crisis (Agadir Crisis) in July 1911?	☐	☐	☐	
50	How was the 1911 Agadir Crisis officially resolved between France and Germany?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
51	By 1914, approximately what percentage of the African continent had been brought under European colonial control?	☐	☐	☐	
52	Which German Foreign Secretary delivered the famous 1897 Reichstag speech declaring that Germany demanded its "place in the sun"?	☐	☐	☐	
53	How did the First Moroccan Crisis paradoxically affect the diplomatic relationship between Great Britain and France?	☐	☐	☐	
54	How did Kaiser Wilhelm II physically arrive in Tangier in 1905 to maximize spectacle and challenge French authority?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Which senior British minister delivered the defiant Mansion House speech in July 1911, warning Germany that Britain would not be treated as of no account?	☐	☐	☐	
56	What name was given to the territory in Central Africa ceded by France to German Kamerun to settle the 1911 Agadir Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What economic interpretation of the Scramble for Africa was famously advanced by Marxist theorist V.I. Lenin in 1916?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What counter-argument do revisionist historians such as A.J.P. Taylor make regarding colonial rivalries in Africa as a cause of the First World War?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What strategic waterway in Egypt, opened in 1869, made British control of North and East Africa an essential imperial priority?	☐	☐	☐	
60	According to modern historian Margaret MacMillan, what was	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	the primary lasting danger of the Moroccan Crises?				

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Date: _____

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What revolutionary all-big-gun British battleship was launched in December 1906, transforming global naval warfare?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Which German Admiral was appointed State Secretary of the Imperial Navy Office in 1897 to build Germany's High Seas Fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
63	What traditional British naval doctrine mandated that the Royal Navy must equal the combined strength of the next two largest navies?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What term describes the century of British global maritime dominance between the Battle of Trafalgar (1805) and the early 1900s?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Why did the launch of HMS Dreadnought inadvertently create a severe strategic dilemma for Great Britain?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What was the central principle of Admiral Tirpitz's "Risk Theory" (Risikogedanke)?	☐	☐	☐	
67	What popular protest slogan was chanted by British politicians and the public in 1909 demanding eight new dreadnoughts?	☐	☐	☐	
68	Why did British strategists view the expansion of the German High Seas Fleet as an existential threat?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Which legislative measures passed in 1898 and 1900 provided the legal and financial framework to build Germany's battle fleet?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
70	By August 1914, what was the final comparative score of dreadnought-class capital ships completed by Britain and Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
71	Which visionary and ruthless British Admiral was appointed First Sea Lord in October 1904 and drove the creation of HMS Dreadnought?	☐	☐	☐	
72	In what record-breaking construction time was HMS Dreadnought built at Portsmouth Royal Dockyard?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What revolutionary propulsion technology was installed in HMS Dreadnought, enabling sustained top speeds of 21 knots?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What massive civil engineering project was Imperial Germany forced to undertake between 1907 and 1914 so its dreadnoughts could traverse between the Baltic and North Seas?	☐	☐	☐	
75	What diplomatic controversy erupted in October 1908 when Kaiser Wilhelm II publicly declared that the English were "mad as March hares"?	☐	☐	☐	
76	Which two radical Liberal ministers initially opposed building eight dreadnoughts in 1909 to protect funding for old age pensions before yielding to cabinet pressure?	☐	☐	☐	
77	What influential thesis was advanced by historian Paul Kennedy in "The Rise of the Anglo-German Antagonism" (1980)?	☐	☐	☐	
78	What counter-argument do modern military historians such as Hew Strachan advance	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	regarding the naval race by 1912?				
79	What new naval weapon increasingly threatened dreadnought capital ships before 1914, leading Jackie Fisher to accurately predict that submarines would dominate future warfare?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What was the primary geopolitical consequence of the Anglo-German naval rivalry for British foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Date: _____

Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	Which three great powers formed the Triple Alliance in 1882?	☐	☐	☐	
82	Which three nations formed the counterbalancing Triple Entente by 1907?	☐	☐	☐	
83	What traditional British foreign policy of avoiding long-term continental alliances was abandoned after 1900?	☐	☐	☐	
84	What was the primary strategic objective of Otto von Bismarck's foreign policy following German unification in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
85	What defensive military alliance was signed between Germany and Austria-Hungary in October 1879?	☐	☐	☐	
86	In what year did France and Tsarist Russia conclude their breakthrough military convention, ending French diplomatic isolation?	☐	☐	☐	
87	What colonial agreement was signed between Great Britain and France in April 1904, settling disputes in Egypt and Morocco?	☐	☐	☐	
88	Which 1907 diplomatic convention resolved imperial rivalries in Persia, Afghanistan, and Tibet, completing the Triple Entente?	☐	☐	☐	
89	What German foreign policy term, meaning "world policy", reflected Kaiser Wilhelm II's ambition for global imperial status?	☐	☐	☐	
90	Which nation was widely regarded as the "weak link" in	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	the Triple Alliance due to its territorial rivalries with Austria-Hungary?				
91	What secret 1887 treaty pledged neutrality between Germany and Russia, which Kaiser Wilhelm II foolishly allowed to lapse in 1890?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What primary economic motivation compelled autocratic Tsarist Russia to ally with the democratic French Third Republic in 1894?	☐	☐	☐	
93	What top-secret correspondence between Helmuth von Moltke and Franz Conrad von Hötzendorf in January 1909 converted a defensive alliance into an offensive commitment?	☐	☐	☐	
94	What regional crisis in October 1908 brought Europe to the brink of war when Austria-Hungary formally annexed an Ottoman province?	☐	☐	☐	
95	What is the central argument of the "Doomsday Machine" thesis of the alliance system, championed by historians like Sidney Fay and Luigi Albertini?	☐	☐	☐	
96	What counter-interpretation do modern historians such as Margaret MacMillan advance regarding the role of alliances in July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
97	What secret agreement did Italy sign with France in 1902, directly undermining its commitments to the Triple Alliance?	☐	☐	☐	
98	Why did Field Marshal von Schlieffen calculate that Germany had to knock out France in six weeks before turning to face Russia?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
99	Which British Foreign Secretary presided over the formation of the Triple Entente and attempted to mediate the July Crisis of 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
100	For how many consecutive years did the European alliance system maintain general peace among the great powers before 1914?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

Why did thirty days in July 1914 lead to world war?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	In which Austro-Hungarian provincial capital was Archduke Franz Ferdinand assassinated on 28 June 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
102	What was the name of the 19-year-old Bosnian Serb nationalist who fired the fatal shots killing Franz Ferdinand and Duchess Sophie?	☐	☐	☐	
103	What secret Serbian nationalist society supplied the weapons, cyanide, and training for the Sarajevo assassins?	☐	☐	☐	
104	What historic Serbian national holiday fell on 28 June, commemorating the 1389 Battle of Kosovo against the Ottoman Empire?	☐	☐	☐	
105	What unconditional diplomatic and military pledge was issued by Kaiser Wilhelm II to Austria-Hungary on 5 July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
106	What diplomatic document was delivered by Austria-Hungary to Serbia at 6:00 PM on 23 July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
107	On what date did Austria-Hungary officially declare war on Serbia, beginning the artillery bombardment of Belgrade?	☐	☐	☐	
108	What German war plan mandated an immediate, massive strike through neutral Belgium into northern France once mobilization began?	☐	☐	☐	
109	What 1839 international treaty guaranteed Belgian neutrality, which Britain honoured by declaring war on Germany on 4 August 1914?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
110	What dismissive phrase was used by German Chancellor Bethmann-Hollweg to describe the 1839 Treaty of London to the British ambassador?	☐	☐	☐	
111	What initial assassination attempt on Franz Ferdinand failed on the morning of 28 June 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
112	Why was Gavrilo Princip standing outside Schiller's Delicatessen when Franz Ferdinand's car unexpectedly stopped right in front of him?	☐	☐	☐	
113	Which head of Serbian Military Intelligence, known by the codename "Apis", secretly orchestrated the Black Hand assassination plot?	☐	☐	☐	
114	Which specific demand in the Austro-Hungarian ultimatum (Point 6) did Serbia reject as an intolerable violation of sovereign independence?	☐	☐	☐	
115	Which Austro-Hungarian Chief of General Staff had urged a preventative war against Serbia over twenty-five times since 1906?	☐	☐	☐	
116	What urgent series of personal telegrams were exchanged between the German Kaiser and Russian Tsar between 29 and 31 July 1914 in a desperate bid to avert general war?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What calculated diplomatic delay was engineered by Austro-Hungarian Foreign Minister Count Berchtold before delivering the ultimatum on 23 July?	☐	☐	☐	
118	What landmark thesis was published by German historian Fritz Fischer in 1961 ("Griff nach	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	der Weltmacht") regarding the July Crisis?				
119	How does Australian historian Christopher Clark interpret European leadership in "The Sleepwalkers" (2012)?	☐	☐	☐	
120	What critical mobilization order did Tsar Nicholas II sign on the evening of 30 July 1914, making general European war practically unavoidable?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

End of Unit Assessment: The Historians' Debate

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
121	What was the name of the Austro-Hungarian heir whose assassination on 28 June 1914 catalyzed the July Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
122	Which Serbian nationalist secret society orchestrated the weapons transfer, training, and border smuggling for the Sarajevo assassins?	☐	☐	☐	
123	Which two opposing alliance coalitions divided the European balance of power in August 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
124	What unconditional promise of military support did Imperial Germany extend to Austria-Hungary on 5 July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
125	What German war plan, designed by the Chief of the General Staff in 1905, dictated an immediate offensive through Belgium against France?	☐	☐	☐	
126	What 1839 international treaty guaranteed Belgian neutrality and served as Britain's legal casus belli for entering the war?	☐	☐	☐	
127	Which German historian published "Griff nach der Weltmacht" in 1961, arguing Germany bore primary responsibility for deliberately planning and provoking the war?	☐	☐	☐	
128	What controversial clause in the 1919 Treaty of Versailles (Article 231) forced Germany to accept sole responsibility for causing the war?	☐	☐	☐	
129	Which naval arms race from 1898 to 1912 poisoned relations between Great Britain and Imperial Germany?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
130	How do revisionist historians such as Christopher Clark ("The Sleepwalkers") characterize the outbreak of the First World War?	☐	☐	☐	
131	What archival document from September 1914 did Fritz Fischer highlight to prove German premeditated expansionist ambitions?	☐	☐	☐	
132	What primary cause for the outbreak of war is emphasized by revisionist historian Sean McMeekin in "The Russian Origins of the First World War" (2011)?	☐	☐	☐	
133	What controversial argument does British historian Niall Ferguson advance in "The Pity of War" (1998) regarding Britain's entry into the war?	☐	☐	☐	
134	According to military historian John Keegan, how did rigid railway mobilization timetables undermine diplomatic crisis management in July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
135	What interwar revisionist thesis was advanced by American historian Sidney Fay in "The Origins of the World War" (1928)?	☐	☐	☐	
136	What was the central ideological principle of Pan-Slavism that made Russia feel honour-bound to defend Serbia in July 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
137	Why did the German High Command (Moltke and Falkenhayn) believe that a European war had to be fought in 1914 rather than delayed until 1917?	☐	☐	☐	
138	What was the "Short War Illusion" universally shared by European populations and military planners in August 1914?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
139	What term was widely applied to the volatile Balkan region prior to 1914 because of its extreme ethnic nationalism and competing imperial rivalries?	☐	☐	☐	
140	In evaluating the four long-term causes of the Great War (M-A-I-N), what do most contemporary historians agree was the decisive mechanism that made war unavoidable?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

1. 39
2. Prussia
3. Otto von Bismarck
4. Blood and iron
5. Warfare and military strength
6. Denmark, Austria, France
7. 1870
8. Palace of Versailles
9. 18 January 1871
10. Alsace-Lorraine
11. Zollverein
12. Austria
13. Kaiserreich
14. Seven weeks
15. Wilhelm I
16. To unite the southern German states with the north
17. Napoleon III
18. Coal and iron
19. It created long-term rivalry and hatred between France and Germany
20. A massive, powerful, militaristic state suddenly appeared in the center of Europe

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

21. Otto von Bismarck
22. Ems Telegram
23. 1870
24. Alsace and Lorraine
25. Palace of Versailles
26. 5 billion francs
27. Kaiser Wilhelm II
28. Reinsurance Treaty
29. France
30. A two-front war
31. Schlieffen Plan

- 32. Napoleon III**
- 33. To unify the southern German states with the north**
- 34. Alsace-Lorraine**
- 35. Wilhelm I**
- 36. Editing the Ems Telegram**
- 37. He was captured along with his army**
- 38. Treaty of Frankfurt**
- 39. It would force Germany into a two-front war**
- 40. The Hall of Mirrors at Versailles**

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

41. The Scramble for Africa
42. King Leopold II of Belgium
43. 1884
44. Kaiser Wilhelm II
45. Great Britain
46. 1905
47. He declared support for Moroccan independence and the Sultan as a free sovereign ruler
48. Germany was diplomatically isolated, with only Austria-Hungary supporting its position
49. Dispatching the gunboat SMS Panther to the Moroccan port of Agadir
50. Germany recognized France's Moroccan protectorate in exchange for ceding a strip of French Congo to German Kamerun
51. Approximately 90% (up from 10% in 1870)
52. Bernhard von Bülow
53. It converted the informal 1904 Entente Cordiale into a robust, coordinated military and naval partnership
54. Riding through the streets on a white horse surrounded by an armed escort to meet the Sultan's representatives
55. David Lloyd George (Chancellor of the Exchequer)
56. Neukamerun (New Cameroon)
57. Imperialism was the highest stage of capitalism, driven by monopolies desperately seeking raw materials, captive markets, and outlets for surplus capital
58. Colonial disputes in Africa were all resolved through peaceful diplomatic bargaining and did not directly trigger the war of 1914
59. The Suez Canal
60. They convinced German leaders that future diplomatic negotiations were useless and only military strength could achieve prestige

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

61. HMS Dreadnought
62. Admiral Alfred von Tirpitz
63. The Two-Power Standard
64. Pax Britannica
65. It rendered Britain's huge fleet of older pre-dreadnought battleships obsolete, resetting the naval race to zero
66. Building a German fleet large enough that Britain would not risk attacking it for fear of losing naval supremacy to other powers
67. "We want eight and we won't wait!"
68. Britain was an island dependent on maritime imports for two-thirds of its food, whereas Germany had no vital overseas supply lines

- 69. The German Naval Laws (Flottengesetze)**
- 70. Britain had completed 29 dreadnoughts compared to Germany's 17**
- 71. Admiral Sir John "Jackie" Fisher**
- 72. 366 days (one year and one day)**
- 73. Parsons steam turbine engines**
- 74. Widening and deepening the Kiel Canal**
- 75. The Daily Telegraph Affair**
- 76. David Lloyd George and Winston Churchill**
- 77. Naval Determinism: the naval arms race was the single decisive structural cause that permanently destroyed Anglo-German relations and made war inevitable**
- 78. The naval arms race had effectively ended in British victory by 1912, and land army expansions on the Continent became the true driver of 1914 tensions**
- 79. The automotive torpedo and the submarine (U-boat)**
- 80. It forced Great Britain to abandon Splendid Isolation and conclude defensive ententes with its historic rivals, France and Russia**

Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?

81. Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy
82. Great Britain, France, and Russia
83. Splendid Isolation
84. To keep France diplomatically isolated and prevent Germany from facing a two-front war
85. The Dual Alliance
86. 1894
87. The Entente Cordiale
88. The Anglo-Russian Convention
89. Weltpolitik
90. Italy
91. The Reinsurance Treaty
92. Massive French financial loans and capital investment to build Russian railways and modernize heavy industry
93. The Moltke-Conrad Dispatches
94. The Bosnian Annexation Crisis
95. The interlocking military treaties created an automated chain reaction where a localized Balkan dispute inevitably dragged all European great powers into total war
96. Alliances did not make war inevitable; European leaders made conscious, aggressive political choices to mobilize and declare war rather than acting as helpless victims of treaties
97. The Prinetti-Barrère Agreement
98. Russia's vast geography and underdeveloped railway network meant its military mobilization would take six weeks, creating a temporary window of opportunity
99. Sir Edward Grey
100. 43 years (from the Treaty of Frankfurt in 1871 until August 1914)

Why did thirty days in July 1914 lead to world war?

101. Sarajevo
102. Gavrilo Princip
103. The Black Hand (Union or Death)
104. Vidovdan (St. Vitus Day)
105. The "Blank Cheque"
106. A 10-point ultimatum with a strict 48-hour deadline
107. 28 July 1914
108. The Schlieffen Plan
109. The Treaty of London
110. A mere "scrap of paper"

- 111.** Nedeljko Čabrinović threw a bomb that bounced off the Archduke's car and exploded beneath the following vehicle
- 112.** The driver, Leopold Lojka, took a wrong turn onto Franz Josef Street and stalled the engine while attempting to reverse
- 113.** Colonel Dragutin Dimitrijević
- 114.** Allowing Austro-Hungarian police and judicial officials to participate in proceedings on Serbian sovereign territory
- 115.** Field Marshal Franz Conrad von Hötzendorf
- 116.** The "Willy-Nicky" Telegrams
- 117.** Waiting until French President Raymond Poincaré had finished his state visit to St. Petersburg and boarded his warship home
- 118.** Imperial Germany deliberately provoked the July Crisis and encouraged Austria to attack Serbia to wage a premeditated war for European hegemony and world power
- 119.** European leaders acted like sleepwalkers, blinded by mutual paranoia and domestic pressures, rather than executing a unilateral German conspiracy
- 120.** General mobilization of the entire Russian army and navy

End of Unit Assessment: The Historians' Debate

121. Archduke Franz Ferdinand
122. The Black Hand (Union or Death)
123. The Triple Entente and the Triple Alliance
124. The "Blank Cheque"
125. The Schlieffen Plan
126. The Treaty of London
127. Fritz Fischer
128. The War Guilt Clause
129. The Dreadnought arms race
130. As a tragic collective breakdown of diplomacy where European statesmen blindly sleepwalked into a catastrophe that none truly wanted
131. The "Septemberprogramm" drafted by Chancellor Bethmann-Hollweg, outlining sweeping annexations in Europe and Africa
132. Tsarist Russia's aggressive geopolitical ambition to dismantle the Ottoman Empire and seize Constantinople and the Turkish Straits
133. Great Britain made a catastrophic strategic blunder by intervening, transforming a manageable continental clash into a ruinous global bloodbath
134. Once general mobilization was declared, millions of reservists and train schedules could not be stopped without throwing armies into defenseless chaos
135. No single nation was solely responsible; all European powers were collectively ensnared by secret diplomacy, militarism, nationalism, and economic rivalry
136. The belief that the Russian Empire had a sacred historic duty to protect Slavic peoples and Orthodox Christians in the Balkans from Austro-German domination
137. Russia's "Great Military Programme" was rapidly modernizing its armed forces and strategic railways, which would make Germany militarily indefensible by 1917
138. The mistaken belief that modern industrial firepower would produce a rapid, decisive victory and soldiers would be home by Christmas
139. The "Powder Keg of Europe"
140. The lethal intersection of rigid alliance tripwires, uncompromising military mobilization timetables, and reckless brinkmanship during the July Crisis

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 140 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/140)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...